

Varsity VEX V5: Guidelines & Expectations

2026–2027 Season

Team Values

All VEX team members are expected to embody the following values:

- Respectful – Treat others, equipment, and the workspace with care.
- Kind – Foster a supportive and inclusive team environment.
- Helpful – Contribute positively to your team and others.
- Resourceful – Take initiative and problem-solve independently.
- Growth-Oriented – Learn from mistakes and continuously improve.

KIS Academic Expectations

Grades will be checked bi-weekly from September through March during the VEX season. If academic issues arise due to missed work from VEX participation, the VEX coaching staff will work with both the student and their teachers to help resolve the issue and ensure all missing or late work is completed. Failure to maintain academic standing may result in the tiered consequences process outlined in this document. In addition to the expectations outlined by the VEX program, all members are also expected to follow the attendance and eligibility requirements stated in the Athletics & Co-Curricular Handbook.

As a basic expectation:

Students must attend all classes the day before an away trip that includes an early release.

Example: If a student is released at 2:00 p.m. on Friday for travel, they must attend all classes on Thursday.

Students must also attend all classes on the day of a game, practices, scrimmage, tournament, or travel departure until the designated release/departure time. Failure to meet school attendance requirements may affect eligibility to participate in VEX-related events and travel opportunities.

Reference: Attendance Requirements/Policy → [Academic & Athletics Handbook](#)

Varsity Letter Criteria

Students may earn a Varsity Letter in VEX Robotics by meeting all criteria below.

Participation

- Be an active member of the Friday VEX Club
- Attend all designated mandatory after-school sessions
- Attendance is expected whenever sessions are marked as mandatory
- Travel to and actively participate in:
 - KAIAC Scrimmages
 - KAIAC Finals
 - VEX Nationals
- Exceptions for missing scrimmages due to robot maintenance must be approved by the Head Coach

- KAIAC Finals and Korea VEX Nationals are required for Varsity Letter consideration

Organization & Time Management

- Maintain a well-organized toolbox for efficient repairs and maintenance
- Toolboxes will be checked monthly during club sessions

- Consistently missing toolbox checks may affect Varsity Letter eligibility

Engineering Performance

- Robots must consistently score in at least two aspects of the game
- Teams must demonstrate performance in both:
 - Autonomous
 - Driver Control

Documentation

Maintain a detailed engineering notebook including:

- Monthly entries
- Sketches and photos
- Robot revisions and changes
- Team goals and reflections
- Scrimmage results and analysis



Attendance Requirements

The VEX Robotics program recognizes that athletics and extracurricular activities are an important part of a student's high school experience. This attendance policy is designed to provide reasonable flexibility while maintaining commitment, reliability, and fairness to all team members.

Weekly Meeting Expectations

- After-school sessions will be held on:
 - Tuesday
 - Fridays
- One session per week is mandatory
- Members may choose which scheduled day to attend
- One Saturday session will be held each month
- Coaches will attempt to schedule Saturday sessions at times that accommodate the majority of members

**** Tuesday & Friday after school sessions are subject to change based on circumstances throughout the year ****



Extracurricular Activity Excused Absence Policy

Members may receive excused absences during one activity season of their choice (Fall or Winter) due to participation in another school-sponsored activity or sport.

Example:

A student who participates in volleyball during the Fall season may be excused from regular after-school VEX sessions during the Fall.

If the same student later participates in a Winter activity, those absences will not be excused and will count toward their allotted unexcused absences.

This policy applies to:

- Sports
- Quiz Bowl
- Debate
- Speech
- Performing Arts
- Other school-sponsored extracurricular commitments

Students must provide proof of participation/attendance for missed sessions. Without proof, absences will not be excused.

Important Limitations

Excused seasonal absences apply only to:

- Regular after-school practices
- The approved activity season selected by the student

The following are not excused:

- Saturday sessions
- Scrimmages
- Competitions/Tournaments
- KAIAC

These are considered essential team commitments.



Competition & Event Attendance Requirements

Due to the VEX V5 schedule, the primary competition season will take place during the Fall and Winter seasons.

Team Event Requirements

Each team must attend:

- A minimum of 4 out of 5 official events (excluding KAIAC)

Additionally:

- **KAIAC attendance is mandatory for all members and teams**

Flexibility for Students in Other Activities

Students participating in another extracurricular activity during Fall or Winter must attend:

- 3 out of the 4 required scrimmages

The team as a whole must still meet the full competition attendance requirement.

Members are expected to inform the Head Coach before scrimmage rosters are submitted.



Communication & Notification Expectations

Absences due to:

- Family obligations
- Personal reasons
- School conflicts

must be communicated to the Head Coach in advance whenever possible.

Failure to communicate absences ahead of time may result in the absence being marked unexcused.



Unexcused Absences

Members are allotted a limited number of unexcused absences per semester.

Consequence Progression

- 1 Unexcused Absence → Warning issued
- 2 Unexcused Absences → Meeting with the Head Coach and/or team officers
- 3 Unexcused Absences → Behavioral Tiered Process begins and may include possible removal from the club/team the following semester

Nationals Tournament Eligibility

Participation at Nationals is not automatically granted.

Teams will only be considered eligible if they demonstrate:

- Consistent preparation
- Commitment
- Competitive readiness

Nationals Eligibility Requirements

To be eligible for Nationals, teams must:

- Attend KAIAC
- Have a competition-ready robot
- Maintain a competition-level engineering notebook

Engineering Notebook Expectations

- Engineering notebooks will be reviewed weekly every Friday during Club Block
- Reviews will be conducted by the Head Coach and Officer Team
- Teams must upload notebook progress to the shared team drive
- Uploaded notebooks must be current live working documents

Preparation Expectations

Teams are expected to demonstrate:

- Ongoing robot development
- Consistent notebook documentation
- Meaningful progress throughout the season

Teams may continue improving robots and notebooks over Winter Break prior to Nationals. However, teams must demonstrate sufficient preparedness before the end of the Fall semester. Teams that fail to meet these expectations may not be selected to attend Nationals, regardless of qualification status.

Final Nationals attendance decisions will be made by the Head Coach based on:

- Preparedness
- Consistency
- Representation of the program

Consequences

Consequences for violating attendance or participation expectations may include:

- Loss of Varsity Letter eligibility
- Loss of Varsity pins/awards
- Removal from the club

Severity of consequences will depend on:

- Reason for absence
- Communication
- Prior commitment and dedication

Behavior & Attendance Consequences

The following tiered system applies to academic, behavioral, attendance, participation, and documentation concerns.

Tier 1 – Initial Warning

- One-on-one conversation with Head Coach
- Parent and Athletics/Activities Coordinator notified
- Intervention documented through Tier 1 form

Tier 2 – Second Infraction

- Parents and relevant faculty notified
- Athletics/Activities Coordinator and Principal informed
- Solution-focused meeting held

Tier 3 – Removal from Team

- Dismissal from the team
- Possible ineligibility for future participation
- Determined at Head Coach discretion



Additional Notes

Students involved in other sports or prolonged absences **may be permitted to use autonomous block time in place of after-school VEX sessions at the discretion of the Head Coach.**

Because VEX already offers two after-school sessions each week, **autonomous block substitutions will only be approved as a last-resort option.**

The Head Coach reserves the right to deny autonomous block substitutions if:

- The student is already using autonomous block for other coursework
- The student is not meeting academic expectations
- The student has a pattern of missing mandatory VEX meetings

Student Agreement

Student Name: _____

Student Signature: _____

Parent Name: _____

Parent Signature: _____

Date: _____

Please refer to the VEX 2026–2027 schedule on the team Notion site for all required attendance dates and competition expectations outlined in this contract.